What I saw at that point really impressed me. ASP.NET Core let developers use their existing knowledge of the .NET Framework, and of ASP.NET MVC applications in particular, while baking in current best practices such as dependency injection, strongly typed configuration, and logging. On top of that, you could build and deploy cross-platform. I was sold.

This book came about largely due to my approach to learning about ASP.NET Core. Rather than simply reading documentation and blog posts, I decided to try something new and start writing about what I learned. Each week I would dedicate some time to exploring a new aspect of ASP.NET Core, and I'd write a blog post about it. When the possibility of writing a book came about, I jumped at the chance—another excuse to dive further into the framework!

Since I started this book, a lot has changed, both with the book and ASP.NET Core. The first major release of the framework in June 2016 still had many rough edges, in particular around the tooling experience. With the release of .NET 7 in November 2022, ASP.NET Core has really come into its own, with the APIs and tooling reaching mature levels.

Updates to the framework in .NET 6 and .NET 7 significantly simplified the getting-started experience for newcomers with the introduction of minimal hosting and minimal APIs, which provide a terser, simpler approach to writing APIs, much closer to the experience in other languages. You can get straight into building your app's functionality without having to understand architecture first.

For some experienced ASP.NET Core developers, these changes can feel regressive and unstructured, but if you're one of them, I encourage you to give them a chance and to build your own structure and patterns. For brevity and clarity of the examples in this book, I often put the whole code for your app in one file, but don't think that's how you need to write your